assert time and again that the Copenhagen interpretation is practically universally accepted, assert it without reservations, even before an audience of the laity—who are completely at your mercy—it's at the limit of the estimable," he wrote to Max Born in 1960. "Have you no anxiety about the verdict of history?" Yet when Bohm wrote to Schrödinger about the pilot-wave interpretation, he received only a reply from his secretary, who said that Schrödinger wasn't interested in his work. "Schrödinger does not deign to write me himself, but he deigned to let his secretary tell me that His Eminence feels that it is irrelevant that mechanical models can be found for the quantum theory," grumbled Bohm. "Of course, his Eminence did not find it necessary to read my papers.… In Portuguese, I would call Schrödinger 'um burro,' and leave it for you to guess the translation." Schrödinger was preoccupied with his own attempt to interpret quantum physics, a picture of the quantum world in which there was only a wave function, with no particles at all. Particles guided by pilot waves were wholly uninteresting to him.

Most disappointing of all, though, was Einstein's reaction to Bohm's work. Einstein was certainly sympathetic to Bohm's motivations—it was Einstein's advice that had given Bohm the courage to develop his ideas in the first place—but he was not at all pleased with the answer that Bohm had arrived at. "Have you noticed that Bohm believes (as de Broglie did, by the way, 25 years ago) that he is able to interpret the quantum theory in deterministic terms?" Einstein wrote to his old friend Max Born. "That way seems too cheap to me."

Einstein's letter didn't go on to explain what, exactly, was "too cheap" about Bohm's ideas. But the pilot-wave interpretation did have a few features that were clearly unacceptable to Einstein. Objects could move in strange ways or fail to move at all when it seemed like they should. Einstein pointed out that in Bohm's theory, a particle trapped in a box could be motionless despite having an enormous amount of kinetic energy (energy of motion). This contradicted the principle that quantum physics should agree with classical physics for large objects. In reply, Bohm pointed out that in such a situation, if you opened the box, the walls of the box would interact with the particle, ensuring the previously motionless particle would go shooting out of the box at high speed—a high speed corresponding to the kinetic energy it had before the box was opened in the first place. Strange,